Colouring with chalk

Synopsis:

Today the children went outside to explore their creativity using chalk. It was a nice bright sunny breezy day. The children were drawing in the shade side of the concrete using different colours to express their creativity. As they were all engaging in conversation, talking about their creations, they were also asking questions and responding to one other's questions while exploring their own curiosity.



1) Which foundations for learning are evident? How do you know? See How does learning happen? (OMED,2014a)

Joseph:

Belonging, Engagement, and Expression are all being shown here. Belonging with all the children together being both respectful and curious about each other's drawings. Engagement with children wanting to pick up a piece of chalk and draw what they want to draw. Lastly, Expression with all the children expressing themselves with what they've drawn on the floor whether it be a heart, sun, or shot.

Keerthika:

Well-being is evident as the children participate in an outdoor chalk experience where they can independently access the materials and engage in the activity in their own way. The children are able to choose where and how they participate, supporting their active and comfortable involvement in the experience.



TIME : 2:14 (Question 10)

Juhi:

Expression and Engagement are evident during the chalk art activity. The children are engaged as they use chalk to draw, create different shapes and colors, for example sun, heart, red, pink, yellow and express their ideas. They show creativity and communicate their thoughts through their art work. The children explore the materials and make their own choices in their learning.

Preety:

Belonging,Engagement, and Expression are evident. The children participate together, show curiosity about the materials, and express their ideas through drawing and communication.

Cintia:

We see children are asking questions about one another's drawing, this demonstrates they are connecting with one another. This refers to a sense of belonging as they are trying to connect with one another about their drawings, and are engaging in a shared experience as well as deepening their relationships with those around them. They are able to express themselves through communication freely and without trouble. Not only are they communicating with one another about their creations, but also engaged in what they are doing individually. This demonstrates engagement as they are focused and involved in making their creations which is essential for learning.

Pedagogical Discussion:

The children's chalk-drawing experience demonstrates expression as they communicate their ideas, creativity, and thoughts through drawing and conversations. In the video, the children choose different colours, create their own drawings, and share their interpretations with others. "Expression or communication (to be heard, as well as to listen) may take many different forms" (Ontario Ministry of Education, 2014, p. 8). This shows that children use their drawings and conversations to communicate their ideas, while educators can support their expression by listening to their thoughts and valuing their creative choices. This connects to the Expression foundation in How Does Learning Happen, which recognizes that children communicate and express themselves in different ways. As educators, we can support children's expression by listening to their ideas, valuing their creative choices, and providing opportunities for them to share their thinking through art and conversation.

2) What would your next actions be and why? In other words, what might you/ the educators do to make the play more responsive and inclusive?

Preety:

We would provide different art materials and allow children to choose what they want to create. We would ask open-ended questions and encourage children to share their ideas. This would make the activity more responsive to their interests and give them more control over their learning.“I would observe first. I would listen to what the children are interested in and then choose the next step based on that.”

Joseph :

I think we could gather outside materials with the children and have them collect sticks, rocks, leaves, etc and use those materials we’ve gathered to either add on to those who want to go that extra step and add details towards their drawing, or help assist those who need a helping building off of the materials they gathered that way we everybody can feel included and have a drawing they can be proud of.

Keerthika :

We could revisit the children's drawings with them and invite them to explain how their ideas developed while drawing alongside their peers. We could then provide opportunities for children to build on one another's ideas through collaborative drawing. This would extend the social and creative learning already occurring in the experience.

Juhi:

We can provide different art supplies and let the children choose what they want to make based on their creativity and ideas in the outdoor environment. We can ask the children open-ended questions about their experiences and what they see in their drawings. This can help children remember their ideas and think about what they want to draw. I would also suggest providing outside loose part materials such as sticks, wooden pieces, stones, caps, shells, leaves, and glow-in-the-dark , glass materials. These materials can help support children’s creativity, exploration in the activity.I will first observe the children’s interests and use their ideas to decide which materials to add. This supports engagement because children can choose materials and explore their own ideas



Time: 6:17 (Question 13)

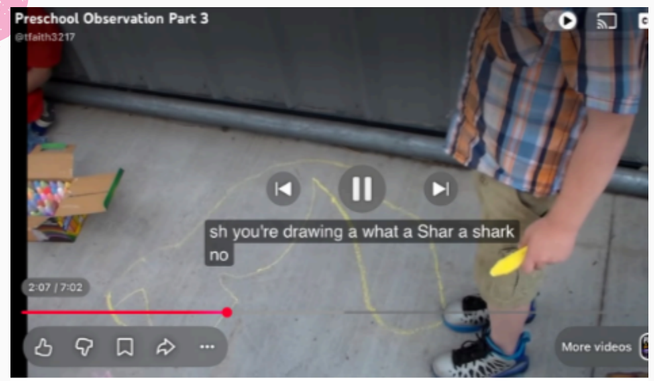
Pedadgogical Discussion:

The children's chalk drawing experience shows us the importance of building on children's interests when planning future learning opportunities. According to HDLH, “When children initiate experiences, generate ideas, plan, problem-solve, make meaningful choices, and act spontaneously through play” (OMEd, 2014, p. 35), they are more likely to be engaged in learning. In the video, the children independently create drawings, choose colours, and share ideas through conversations. This reminds us that educators should observe and listen to children before deciding on the next steps. By revisiting their drawings and inviting them to share their thinking, educators can plan experiences that extend children's interests and support meaningful engagement. When educators take a purposefully curious approach to new experiences and ideas rather than acting as the expert, children are more likely to engage in creative problem solving and more complex play and inquiry” (OMEd, 2014, pg. 35, para. 3). Our practice begins by closely observing what sparks children’s curiosity, then inviting them to choose their own art supplies and loose parts. By blending open ended materials, outdoor exploration, asking questions to explore curiosity, we move away from inflexible, educator-led crafts toward a responsive approach that keeps children deeply involved. We honor the children as capable co-explorers, creating an inclusive environment where their unique ideas shape their play, build complex problem-solving skills, and foster a genuine sense of belonging and engagement.

Cintia:

By incorporating different materials into the children's play, can we give the children the options to choose different materials to add to their creations. By adding natural element materials we would be able to make the children's play more responsive and inclusive. Perhaps after drawing their creations we can explore the outside materials and collect things such as sticks, leaves, grass etc.. to make the drawings feel more real. . For example, collecting leaves to use as hair for the person they're drawing, or collecting sticks to put around the sun. Along with that, engaging the children in conversation they can relate to their own lives. In the video we see the educator discussing the topic of rain and asking children “what does rain ruin” getting them to explore their thinking.

3)WHICH STEREOTYPES DO THE CHILDREN CHALLENGE?



Time: 2:07 (Question 6)

Preety:
The children challenge the stereotype that children's artwork should always be clear, recognizable or easy for adults to understand. Child D says who knows what i am drawing showing that his artwork does not need to have one clear meaning. Child E sees it as a shark, showing that children can have their own interpretations and ideas.

Pedagogical Discussion:

The children's chalk-drawing experience connects to the Belonging foundation because they participate in a shared activity while maintaining their individual ideas and interpretations. The children challenge the assumption that there is only one correct way to create or understand artwork. For example, when Child D says, “Who knows what I am drawing,” and another child interprets the drawing as a shark, we see different perspectives being shared within the group. According to How Does Learning Happen?, Belonging involves feeling connected to others, being valued, and contributing as part of a group (Ontario Ministry of Education, 2014, p. 7). This reminds educators to create inclusive environments where every child's ideas are respected, differences are valued, and children feel comfortable participating alongside their peers.

Juhi:
The children challenge the stereotype that colours are only for girls and boys. They freely choose colors such as pink, red, black, yellow for their drawing. This shows that children can choose any color based on their own preferences. Also they choose subjects such as sunny, grass, and hearts to represent their ideas. The educator asks what are you drawing? Child A response quickly “A heart” showing confidence in sharing and owing their ideas and creativity.

Joseph:
The role that the environment plays as the third teacher is being the canvas for the children to express their articular side and have them draw to their hearts desired

Cintia:
The children face the stereotype of putting a description to what they’re drawing. For example, in the video the educator asks Child E what they are drawing, in which he does not give a response right away and Child D says “Who knows what he's drawing”. Another Child states “A penguin” whereas another child states “He’s drawing a giant, giant, Easter Bunny” This goes to show all children have different ways they use their imagination so by letting them explore their own imagination through drawing, we eliminate such stereotypes.

Keerthika:
The outdoor environment acts as a “third teacher” by providing real experiences that become part of the children’s conversations and thinking. As they draw outdoors, the children connect their play to the weather, discussing rain and its effects on themselves (Example: rain ruins your hair good) and their surroundings and experiences.



Time: 1:49 (Question 6)

4) What role does the environment, as the “third teacher,” play in the children’s learning and play?

Preety:

The children challenge the stereotype that children's artwork should always be clear, recognizable or easy for adults to understand. Child D says who knows what i am drawing showing that his artwork does not need to have one clear meaning. Child E sees it as a shark, showing that children can have their own interpretations and ideas.

Keerthika:

The outdoor environment acts as a “third teacher” by providing real experiences that become part of the children’s conversations and thinking. As they draw outdoors, the children connect their play to the weather, discussing rain and its effects on themselves (Example: rain ruins your hair good) and their surroundings and experiences.



Time: 6:23 (Question 12)

Pedagogical Discussion:

The outdoor environment provides opportunities for children's ideas, conversations, and exploration to develop naturally during play. HDLH explains that “The environment was described by Loris Malaguzzi as ‘the third teacher’ and is valued for its power to organize, promote relationships, and educate” (OMEd, 2014, p. 20). In the video, the children draw on the concrete while discussing the sun, rain, and how rain affects things around them. These conversations show that the environment is not simply a place for drawing; it also influences what children notice, discuss, and connect to their everyday experiences. This encourages educators to consider how different spaces and materials can create new possibilities for children's learning.

Joseph:

The role that the environment plays as the third teacher is being the canvas for the children to express their articular side and have them draw to their hearts desired. If the drawing experience were to be taken inside what would shift would be the materials used to create their drawing, since more materials are available to them now and their drawing can be expressed on paper with markers, crayons, paint, or with recyclable materials that's found within the classroom. The conversation would probably change since instead of being contained in a small area drawing they would be spread out in the classroom talking to others probably paired up with their preferred peers and flow of conversation would change compared to being one big group.

Juhi:

The outdoor environment helps children feel energy and gives them the freedom to choose colours, draw what they desire. Some children choose to draw the sun while others draw hearts. Children can look at the sun and connect what they see around them to their drawings. If they go indoors to the art area, their ideas change to crayon, markets, paper, paint and loose parts. Sitting at tables indoors would put them in smaller groups, making conversations quieter. The environment acts as a third teacher by giving children new ways to interact and explore.

Cintia:

The environment plays a huge role in the children's learning and play as well as their development. In this video we see the children are using the concrete as a base for drawings. This is great as they have materials such as chalk to draw out their imagination and share with one another as they do the same thing. As we know the environment is described as a “third teacher” this allows them to think, create and make their drawings by using the outdoor environment to their benefit and allows them to shape their actions positively.

5) What questions do you have for the children? Why these questions in particular?

01. **Cintia :**
What does this drawing mean to you? What does it remind you of? What made you feel like drawing this? I would ask these questions as it gives me a deeper understanding of their reasoning as to why they decided to draw what they did. For example, a child may talk about drawing a rainbow because they love the way it looks and it reminds them of someone special like their mommy. It gives me the information that I know they are able to make connections to their own lives.

02. **Joseph :**
Some simple and practical questions that I would have for the children would be “Why did you choose that colour to draw your picture?” or “Why did you draw that?” The reason for this is to get a better understanding of their thought process and choice of idea.

03. **Preety :**
I would ask, “Can you tell me more about your drawing?” and “What made you think it was a shark?” These questions help us understand the children's ideas, thinking, and curiosity.

04. **Juhi :**
I would like to ask the children a question: why did you choose the colour? And what made you think it was a heart, sunny and penguin? These questions help me understand how children express their ideas and how they communicate with each other during art play.

05. **Keerthika :**
“Did seeing what the other children were drawing give you any new ideas for your own drawing?” This question would help us understand how children's ideas develop through observing and interacting with their peers during shared creative play.

Pedagogical Discussion:

The children's conversations during the chalk experience show why educators should ask questions that invite children to explain their thinking and explore their ideas further. HDLH describes engagement as “a state of being genuinely involved and interested in what one is doing” (OMEd, 2014, p. 35). By asking open-ended questions about children's drawings, observations, and interactions, educators can better understand what interests them and how they make meaning from their experiences. Listening to their responses supports expression, while using their ideas to guide further exploration supports engagement. This helps educators move beyond simply observing children's play and use their perspectives to inform future learning opportunities.

References

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